

Functional Specification Document

Ethiopia OAN – Grievance Management Module

Version 1.3 August 2026

Version	Description	Author	Date
D1	Initial Draft	Dinesh R	2 July 2026
D2	Updated information for submission channels, submitter types, ticketing workflow, resolution workflow, escalation logic, use cases. Added Appendix A (Submitter Types), Appendix C (Notification Matrix), Appendix D (Department Response Structure), expanded workflow diagrams in Appendix B.	Dinesh R, Hana	24 July 2026
D3	A RBAC and assigned-case access rules, reassignment approval, portal UI requirements, status/display mappings, SLA deferral and L2 approval, administration controls.	Dinesh R, Hana	7 August 2026

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This document defines the functional behavior and operational expectations of the Grievance Management Module within the OpenAgriNet (OAN) Ethiopia ecosystem. The module serves as a foundational accountability mechanism enabling farmers, cooperatives, farmer producer organizations (FPOs), NGOs, and Woreda/Kebele bodies to formally register grievances related to agricultural services and to track them through institutional workflows.

At its core, the module ensures that every grievance submitted is:

- Reliably captured and uniquely identifiable
- Authenticated and linked to a verified identity via Fayda ID
- Routed to the appropriate responsible entity – automatically where rules permit, or manually by a nodal officer
- Transparently tracked across its full lifecycle from submission to closure
- Accompanied by structured responses from responsible departments back to the submitter

1.2 Scope

This specification covers the functional requirements for a minimum viable, scalable grievance tracking system. The scope includes:

- Multi-channel grievance intake: mobile app, web portal, IVR/call center, and Development Agent assisted entry
- Support for multiple submitter types: individual farmers, cooperatives, FPOs, NGOs, and Woreda/Kebele bodies
- Intelligent categorization and automated routing to relevant agencies
- Lifecycle tracking with clearly defined statuses and timestamps
- Structured department response workflow with updates back to the submitter
- SLA-based escalation mechanisms including auto-escalation to senior officers
- Notification services via SMS and email
- Administrative dashboards and analytics

The module explicitly excludes:

- Direct resolution or adjudication of grievances
- Legal dispute management or enforcement actions
- Processing of grievances unrelated to OAN-integrated services

1.3 Definitions

Term	Definition
Fayda ID	Ethiopia's national digital identity system, used for authenticating farmers and submitters within OAN.
Grievance	A formally recorded complaint or issue raised by a submitter concerning an agricultural service or transaction.
Submitter	Any entity authorized to lodge a grievance: individual farmer, cooperative, FPO, NGO, or Woreda/Kebele body.
Service Category	A classification of grievances based on domain (e.g. Inputs, Schemes, Payments, Credit, Markets).
Status Lifecycle	The predefined sequence of states through which a grievance progresses.
SLA	Service Level Agreement – the expected timeframe within which an assigned agency must act on a grievance.
Nodal Officer	The central administrator is responsible for manual routing and oversight of unrouted or escalated grievances.
Ticket Number	A unique, human-readable identifier generated at submission (e.g. OROM-BISH-AGRN-12345).
Woreda/Kebele	Ethiopian sub-regional administrative units used for geographic classification of grievances.

2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

The Grievance Management Module is a core cross-cutting service within the OAN ecosystem. Rather than functioning as an isolated ticketing system, it serves as an interoperable layer connecting submitters with institutional actors such as the Agricultural Transformation Institute (ATI) and the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA). It leverages standardized APIs for seamless data exchange and alignment with existing governmental grievance redress mechanisms.

2.2 Submitter Types and Characteristics

The system supports a broad range of submitters, each with distinct identity and interaction requirements. See also Appendix A for the complete Submitter Types reference.

Submitter type	Identity / verification	Submission channel	Additional fields captured
Individual farmer	Fayda ID (primary) or OTP fallback	Mobile app, IVR, web portal, Development Agent	Farmer ID, land parcel, crop context
Cooperative / FPO	Organization registration number + authorized rep Fayda ID	Web portal, Development Agent, call center	Org name, reg. number, contact person, member count
NGO	Organization name + rep Fayda ID	Web portal, call center	Org name, area covered, authorized rep
Woreda/Kebele body	Body registration / official mandate + rep Fayda ID	Web portal, call center, Development Agent	Body name, Woreda/Kebele, authorized rep
Development Agent (on behalf)	Officer ID + farmer Fayda ID or mobile OTP	Mobile app, web portal	Officer ID recorded; farmer remains primary owner

2.3 Assumptions and Dependencies

- Availability and reliability of the Fayda ID authentication system
- Integration with OAN core registries for farmer, land, and service data
- Functioning SMS gateway for low-connectivity notification
- Configured email accounts per department for structured notifications
- Participation and responsiveness of external agencies and departments

3. Functional Requirements

3.1 Authentication and Identity Management (FR-01)

- Farmers and individual submitters shall authenticate primarily via Fayda ID; OTP-based fallback via registered mobile number is supported.
- Cooperatives, FPOs, and NGOs shall authenticate via organizational credentials with an authorized representative's Fayda ID.
- Development Agents shall authenticate using their officer ID; they may log grievances on behalf of farmers, with the farmer remaining the primary owner.
- Agency and department users shall access the system via role-based access control (RBAC) scoped by role, assigned case, category, department, and region. See section 3.1.1 and Appendix G.
- All submissions shall be uniquely attributed to an authenticated identity to prevent duplicate or fraudulent entries.

3.1.1 Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

The module shall enforce deny-by-default RBAC. A user's ability to act shall be evaluated using role, active status, assigned case, configured category/department/region scope, and any approved reassignment or approval-queue permission. Routing eligibility does not by itself grant edit rights; an explicit case assignment or approval permission is required.

- Farmer users shall access only their own grievances, submit/update their own information, respond to More Info Needed, confirm/reopen a resolution, and manually escalate after SLA elapsed.
- Assisted-Submissions users (Development Agents) shall create and update only grievances recorded as assisted submissions by that officer; the farmer remains the primary owner, and the officer ID is retained for audit.
- L1 Nodal Officers shall act on cases assigned to them within their configured category, department, and region scope. They may review, update status, add internal notes, submit/review responses as permitted, and initiate reassignment when the current department is not appropriate.
- L2 Senior Nodal Officers shall act on their assigned cases and configured approval queues. They shall manage SLA configuration/monitoring and approve or reject SLA deferrals and reassignment requests within their configured category, department, and region scope.
- Department Heads shall act on assigned cases and department-scoped oversight/approval queues. They may manage SLA settings and deferrals for their department and approve department-level actions permitted by policy.
- OAN Administrator-ATI shall have cross-region and cross-department administrative access to manage users, roles, scopes, routing/category assignments, SLAs,

deferrals, notifications, response templates, reassignment approvals, dashboards, and audit access. Immutable audit records shall not be deletable.

3.2 Grievance Submission (FR-02)

The submission process shall be accessible, flexible, and context-aware, supporting all submitter types across all channels.

3.2.1 Submission channels

Channel	Target user	Notes
Mobile app (Android)	Individual farmers, Development Agents	Offline-first; syncs when connectivity restored
Web portal	All submitter types	Responsive; supports file attachments up to 10 MB
Mobile Call	Low-connectivity farmers	Simplified flow; no attachments
IVR helpline	All submitter types	Farmer lodges grievance via call. Agent calls back and updates the grievance fields as required. Agent submits on behalf of farmer who logged call. Agent ID logged.
Development Agent assisted	Farmers in remote areas	Agent enters data, farmer identity linked

3.2.2 Submission form

The system shall dynamically adapt the submission form based on submitter type and selected service category. Core fields common to all submissions:

Field	Required	Notes
Submitter type	Yes	Individual farmer / cooperative / FPO / NGO / Woreda/Kebele body / Development Agent
Submitter name / org name	Yes	Pre-filled if authenticated via Fayda ID
Contact mobile / email	Yes	For notifications
Geographic area	Yes	Region → Zone → Woreda → Kebele
Service category	Yes	Inputs / Schemes / Payments / Credit / Markets

Grievance type	Yes	Dynamically loaded per category
Description	Yes	Free text; min 20 characters
Desired Outcome	No	Free text
Supporting evidence	No	Images, voice recordings; max 10 MB; compressed on upload
Associated service provider	No	Pre-filled from OAN registry if available

3.2.3 Post Submission actions

- Generate a unique ticket number using the scheme: REGION-WOREDA-CATEGORY-SEQUENCE (e.g. OROM-BISH-AGRN-12345)
- Consent confirmation
- Initialize the grievance status as “Submitted”

3.3.1 Case Reassignment and Approval

- An L1 Nodal Officer may select Reassign only when the case is outside the current department's purview. The officer shall select the target department/officer (and region if applicable) and provide a mandatory reason.
- A reassignment request shall remain pending; the target office shall not receive action rights until L2 approval.
- An L2 Senior Nodal Officer shall approve or reject the request. On approval, the target office receives rights to act, and the previous assignment is closed; on rejection, the original assignment remains effective and the requester is notified.
- Every reassignment request and decision shall append an immutable audit entry containing grievance ID, prior assignment, proposed target, reason, initiator, approver, decision, timestamps, and any SLA treatment. SLA reset/continuation shall follow configured policy and shall not be implicit.
- The reassigned officer may act only after the approved assignment is committed.
- Trigger the routing engine to determine the responsible department
- Send an acknowledgement notification to the submitter via SMS and/or email containing: ticket number, category, assigned department (if known), and expected SLA window
- Detect duplicate submissions by comparing submitter identity, grievance type, and temporal proximity; alert the submitter if a match is found

3.3 Routing and Assignment (FR-03)

- Auto-routing rules shall consider: service category, grievance type, geographic area, and associated service provider.
- Where a matching rule exists, the grievance is automatically assigned to the responsible department; status advances to “Assigned”.
- Where no rule matches, the grievance is placed in the nodal officer’s manual routing queue; status remains “Submitted” until assigned.
- In all cases, the assigned department is notified via their configured email account.

3.4 Tracking and Status Management (FR-04)

The canonical grievance lifecycle shall progress through the following statuses. “Rejected” is a terminal state available to an authorised nodal officer or administrator when a grievance is invalid, out of scope, or not accepted for processing. “Escalated” is an overlay flag and does not replace the underlying lifecycle status.

Submitted	Assigned	In Progress	Pending Submitter	Resolved	Closed	Escalated
Awaiting routing	Dept notified	Dept working	Awaiting feedback	Dept closed	Confirmed	SLA breached

A grievance may also be “Reopened” by the submitter after resolution, returning it to “In Progress” with a mandatory reason. The authenticated operations portal may present aggregate filter cards such as Pending, Under Review, and Resolved; these are reporting groups and shall map to canonical statuses without creating duplicate lifecycle states.

3.5 Department Response Workflow (FR-05)

Upon receiving a grievance, each department officer shall interact through a structured response workflow. See also Appendix D for the complete Department Response Structure reference.

- The officer accepts the grievance, advancing status to “In Progress”.
- The officer may request additional information from the submitter (status → “More Info Needed”); the submitter is notified via SMS/email.
- Upon completing investigation, the officer submits a structured response: action taken, resolution summary, attachments, and proposed closure date.
- Each response entry is timestamped, attributed to the responding officer, and appended to the grievance audit trail.
- Submission of the structured response triggers automatic notification to the submitter with the full response and updated status (“Pending Submitter”).

3.6 Submitter Confirmation and Closure (FR-06)

- The submitter receives the department response via SMS/email and may log into the portal to view full details.
- The submitter has a configurable window (default: 7 days) to confirm resolution or reopen the grievance.
- If the submitter confirms satisfaction: status advances to “Resolved”, then auto-closes to “Closed” after a brief cooling period.
- If the submitter is not satisfied: they may reopen with a mandatory reason; status reverts to “In Progress” and the department is re-notified.
- If no response is received within the confirmation window: the system auto-closes the grievance (“Closed – no objection received”).
- Upon closure, the submitter is prompted to provide a satisfaction rating (1–5) and optional qualitative comments.

3.11 Portal and Administrative Console (FR-11)

The supplied Figma prototype represents the authenticated OAN operations portal. It complements, but does not replace, the farmer mobile, IVR, call-centre, and public web submission channels described elsewhere in this specification.

3.11.1 Shared shell and navigation

- Authenticated users shall see a persistent navigation shell with Dashboard, All Grievances, Submit Grievance, Analytics & Reporting, User Management, Administration, and Settings, subject to RBAC visibility.
- The portal shall provide global grievance search, notification indicator, language selection for English and Amharic, user profile access, responsive layouts, and consistent status/priority badges.

3.11.2 Dashboard

- The dashboard shall show KPI cards for Total Grievances, Awaiting Action, Resolved, and Escalated; an escalated-grievance alert; monthly submission versus resolution trend; status distribution; service-category volume; and recent grievances.
- Dashboard cards, charts, and recent records shall use a declared reporting scope and refresh timestamp. Their totals shall reconcile for the same scope; sample/mock data shall not be treated as normative production values.

3.11.3 All Grievances work queue

- The work queue shall provide summary cards for All, Pending, In Progress, Under Review, Resolved, and Rejected. Pending, Under Review, and Resolved are display groups mapped to canonical statuses; the mapping shall be configurable and documented.
- The grievance table shall display ticket ID, derived title/summary, submitter and location, grievance type, attachment count, response count, service category, canonical status, priority, submitted date/time, and a View action.

- Users shall be able to search by ticket ID, title, submitter, grievance type, or region; filter by status, category, priority, region, department, assigned officer, and date range; reset filters; apply filters; choose rows per page; and paginate results.

3.11.4 Grievance detail and response workspace

- The detail view shall provide a chronological Comments & Communication thread, department responses, internal notes not visible to the submitter, attachments, status history, and notification/audit context.
- The case-management panel shall allow an authorised user to set status, assigned officer, department, and Escalated flag, then save the assignment. The SLA tracker shall show consumed percentage, due date, overdue state, and the Defer SLA action.
- The department response form shall support response type, proposed closure date, action taken with a 500-character limit, resolution summary, supporting attachments, and internal notes, consistent with Appendix D.

3.11.5 Submit Grievance wizard

- The portal submission experience shall use three steps: Submitter Identity, Grievance Details, and Review & Submit. Step 1 shall capture submitter type and submission channel, then context-aware identity fields; Step 2 shall capture category, grievance type, location, description, and evidence; Step 3 shall present a review before final submission.
- The wizard shall support Save Draft, Save & Continue, back navigation, mandatory-field indicators, inline validation, and a success state showing the generated ticket number and acknowledgement outcome.
- For Development Agent (on behalf), the interface shall clearly state that the farmer remains the primary grievance owner and that the officer ID is retained for audit purposes.

3.11.6 User Management

- Authorised administrators shall be able to add users, edit roles, activate/deactivate accounts, assign region and role, and view cases handled, status, and contact details. All changes shall be RBAC-protected and audited.

3.11.7 Administration

- Administration shall provide tabs for L1 Nodal Officers, L2 Senior Nodal Officers, Category Assignments, SLA Configuration, Notification Config, and Response Templates.
- Category assignments shall configure service category, department, L1 officer, L2 officer, SLA days, priority, auto-escalation, and notification-on-submit behaviour.
- SLA configuration shall support global maximum deferral days (default maximum 30), auto-escalation threshold, per-category SLA windows, and a deferral approval policy. An L1 officer requesting a deferral shall provide a reason of at least 20 characters and additional days; the request shall require L2 approval unless policy explicitly permits self-approval.
- Notification configuration shall expose the events in Appendix C with enable/disable state, channel, recipient, trigger, and template variables. Response templates shall be versioned and access-controlled.

3.11.8 Localization and validation rules

- The Ethiopia deployment shall use country code +251 and Ethiopian administrative regions. The portal shall support English and Amharic labels and notifications; any prototype sample value that conflicts with Ethiopia shall be corrected before release.
- Ticket numbers shall be unique. Dashboard and work-queue totals shall be computed from the same data scope, and any display label that differs from the canonical status shall have an explicit mapping.

3.7 SLA and Escalation Management (FR-07)

- Each service category shall have a configured SLA (in days) defining the expected response time.
- Send reminder notifications to the assigned officer at 50% and 80% of SLA elapsed.
- On SLA breach: automatically set the “Escalated” flag, raise priority to High, and notify the department head and nodal officer. The portal shall show an SLA tracker with consumed percentage, due date, overdue state, and escalation state.
- On second-level breach (e.g. 2× SLA): escalate to a top-level authority configured per category.
- Log each escalation event in the grievance audit trail with timestamp and reason.
- Allow the submitter to manually trigger escalation once the SLA window has elapsed.

3.8 Notifications and Communication (FR-08)

All notification events and recipients are defined in full in Appendix C (Notification Matrix). SMS messages shall be localized in Amharic and English.

3.9 Reporting and Analytics (FR-09)

Administrators shall have access to dashboards presenting grievance volumes by category and region, SLA compliance rates, average resolution times, farmer satisfaction, escalation rates, and trends. The operations dashboard shall include total grievances, awaiting action, resolved, escalated, monthly submission/resolution trend, status distribution, service-category volume, recent grievances, and an escalation alert with a link to the filtered work queue. Data export (CSV, PDF) and API-based integration with external analytics platforms shall be supported.

3.10 Audit and Compliance (FR-10)

The system shall maintain an immutable record of all actions including grievance creation, status updates, response submissions, escalations, and user interactions. Records shall be protected through encryption and access controls.

4. Workflows

4.1 Grievance Submission and Ticketing Workflow

The following describes the end-to-end flow from the moment a submitter initiates a grievance to the point at which it is assigned to a responsible department. See also Appendix B, Figure B-1 for the visual diagram.

1. Authentication	Submitter authenticates via Fayda ID (individual farmer, cooperative rep, NGO rep, Woreda/Kebele body rep) or agent ID (Development Agent). OTP fallback available for mobile-only users.
2. Select channel	Submitter accesses the grievance form via mobile app, web portal, IVR/helpline, or Development Agent assisted entry. Channel is recorded for audit purposes.
3. Complete form	Submitter selects service category and grievance type. The form dynamically adapts to capture context-specific fields. Supporting evidence (photos, voice) may be attached.
4. Validation	The system validates mandatory fields, file formats and sizes, identity linkage, and checks for duplicate submissions within the defined detection window.
5. Ticket generated	On successful validation: a unique ticket number is generated (REGION-WOREDA-CATEGORY-SEQUENCE), status is set to “Submitted”, and the grievance record is persisted.
6. Acknowledgement	An acknowledgement is immediately dispatched to the submitter via SMS and/or email containing the ticket number, category, and expected SLA window.
7. Routing engine	The routing engine evaluates the grievance against configured rules (service category + grievance type + geographic area + service provider). If a matching rule exists, the grievance is automatically assigned to the responsible department.
8a. Auto-assigned	Status advances to “Assigned”. The department is notified via their configured email account. The submitter is informed of the assigned department.

8b. Manual queue	If no routing rule matches, the grievance enters the nodal officer's manual queue. The nodal officer reviews and assigns to the appropriate department. Status advances to "Assigned" upon manual assignment.
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4.2 Department Response and Resolution Workflow

Once a grievance is assigned, the department officer follows this structured workflow to investigate and respond. See also Appendix B, Figure B-2 for the visual diagram.

1. Dept notified	The department officer receives a notification via the department's configured email account containing full ticket details. An SLA timer starts from the moment of assignment.
2. Accept & begin	The officer opens the ticket in the portal and updates status to "In Progress". The submitter is notified of this status change via SMS.
3. Investigation	The officer investigates the grievance, may add internal notes, and may request additional information from the submitter if required (status → "More Info Needed"). The submitter is notified and given a window to respond.
4. Structured response	On completion, the officer submits a structured response: action taken, resolution summary, supporting attachments, and proposed closure date. This response is logged in the audit trail.
5. Submitter notified	The full response is automatically sent to the submitter via SMS and email. The ticket status advances to "Pending Submitter". A confirmation window (default 7 days) opens.
6a. Confirmed	If the submitter confirms satisfaction within the window, status advances to "Resolved", then auto-closes to "Closed". A satisfaction rating is requested.
6b. Reopened	If the submitter is not satisfied, they reopen with a mandatory reason. Status reverts to "In Progress" and the department officer is re-notified. Steps 3–5 repeat.
6c. Auto-closed	If the submitter does not respond within the confirmation window, the system auto-closes the grievance ("Closed – no objection received") and prompts for feedback.

4.3 SLA Breach and Escalation Workflow

A scheduled background process continuously monitors open grievances against their SLA deadlines and triggers the escalation sequence below. See also Appendix B, Figure B-3 for the visual diagram.

SLA at 50%	Reminder notification sent to assigned officer via email: remaining SLA days, ticket summary.
SLA at 80%	Second reminder to assigned officer. Nodal officer receives a visibility report of all at-risk tickets.
SLA breached	<i>Escalated</i> flag set. Priority raised to High. Department head and nodal officer notified via email. Escalation event logged in audit trail.
2× SLA breached	Second-level escalation to top-level authority (configurable per category). All previous stakeholders remain notified. Grievance appears in escalation dashboard.
Manual escalation	At any point after SLA elapsed, the submitter may manually escalate via the portal or SMS code. This triggers the same notifications as an SLA breach escalation.
Escalation resolved	Once the department submits a structured response, the Escalated flag is cleared and normal resolution steps (section 4.2, steps 5–6) resume.

5. Data Model

Grievance	ticket_number, submitter_type, submitter_id, submitter_name, contact_mobile, contact_email, area (region/zone/woreda/kebele), service_category, grievance_type, description, attachments, status, priority, assigned_dept, assigned_to, escalated (flag), created_at, updated_at
Submitter profile	submitter_type, fayda_id (or org_reg_number), name, contact, area; cooperatives/FPOs/NGOs/Woreda/Kebele bodies carry additional org fields
Grievance response	grievance (link), response_date, action_taken, resolution_summary, attachments, proposed_close_date, responded_by, created_at
Status history	grievance (link), from_status, to_status, changed_by, timestamp, notes
Routing rule	service_category, grievance_type, area, service_provider, assigned_dept, priority (rule precedence)
Department	dept_name, email_account, head_of_dept, senior_officer, nodal_officer, active
SLA configuration	service_category, grievance_type, sla_days, reminder_50_sent, reminder_80_sent
Notification log	grievance (link), event, recipient, channel, message, sent_at, status
Escalation log	grievance (link), escalation_level, triggered_at, triggered_by, notified_stakeholders
<i>RBAC assignment</i>	user_id, role, active, region_scope, department_scope, category_scope, effective_from, effective_to, assigned_by
<i>Reassignment request</i>	grievance (link), initiated_by, prior_department, prior_officer, target_department, target_officer, reason, requested_at, approver, decision, decided_at, sla_treatment
<i>Access audit event</i>	user_id, role, grievance (link), action, scope_evaluated, decision, timestamp, source

6. External Interfaces and Integrations

- OAN registries: farmer identity, land records, crop data, and transaction systems for contextual pre-population of submission forms.
- Fayda ID: authentication and identity verification for all submitter types.
- SMS gateway: primary notification channel that supports Amharic and English.
- Voice IVR system: Voice-based IVR system currently used as Farmer Helpline and used for both incoming systems as grievance registration mechanism using transcription or live agent interaction.
- Email service: department-specific email accounts for structured notifications and responses.
- ATI and MoA institutional systems: bidirectional integration for grievances routed to government bodies.
- External analytics platforms: API-based data export for reporting and policy analysis.

7. Non-Functional Requirements

Attribute	Requirement
Performance	Grievance submission response time $\leq$ 10 seconds under normal load. SLA batch job completes within 30 minutes.
Reliability	99.5% uptime. Offline-capable mobile app with sync on reconnect.
Security	All data encrypted at rest and in transit. RBAC enforced. Audit log immutable.
Usability	Mobile-first, multilingual (Amharic, English), calling support for feature phones.
Scalability	Architecture supports national-scale adoption across all regions and woredas.
Low connectivity scenarios	Mobile app functions offline and syncs on network connectivity IVR channel available using 80XX type incoming number and IVR paths SMS used as primary notification for both registrations as well as changes and updates to the ticket

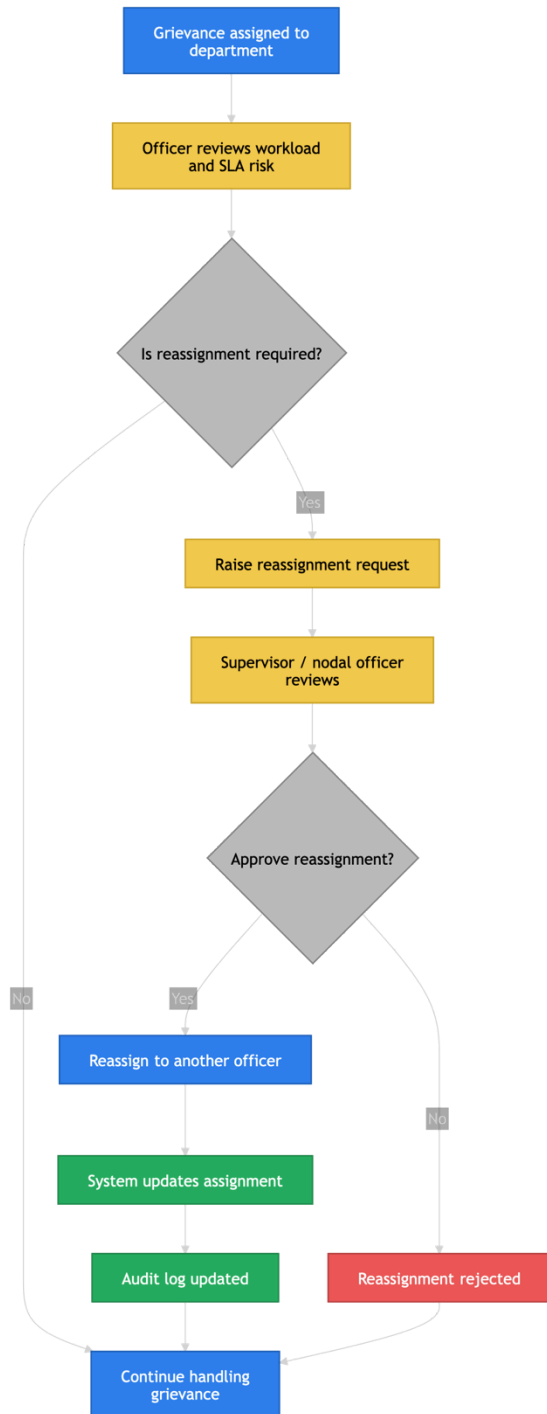
8. Risks and Mitigation Strategies

Low adoption by farmers	Medium	Assisted submission channels, IVR support, Development Agent network, adaptive and usable UX for local contexts.
Delayed responses by agencies	High	SLA enforcement with automated reminders, escalation to senior officer and nodal officer on breach.
Misrouting or responsibility avoidance	Medium	Configurable routing rules with fallback to nodal officer; audit trail of all routing decisions.
Premature or misdirected closures	Medium	Submitter confirmation window, ability to reopen, escalation report listing re-opened items.
Fayda ID unavailability	Low	OTP fallback via registered mobile, Farmer/Land ID, graceful degradation to manual identity verification by Development Agent.
Duplicate or fraudulent submissions	Low	Duplicate detection algorithm on identity + category + time proximity; Fayda ID linkage.

9. Workload Management and Anonymous Grievances

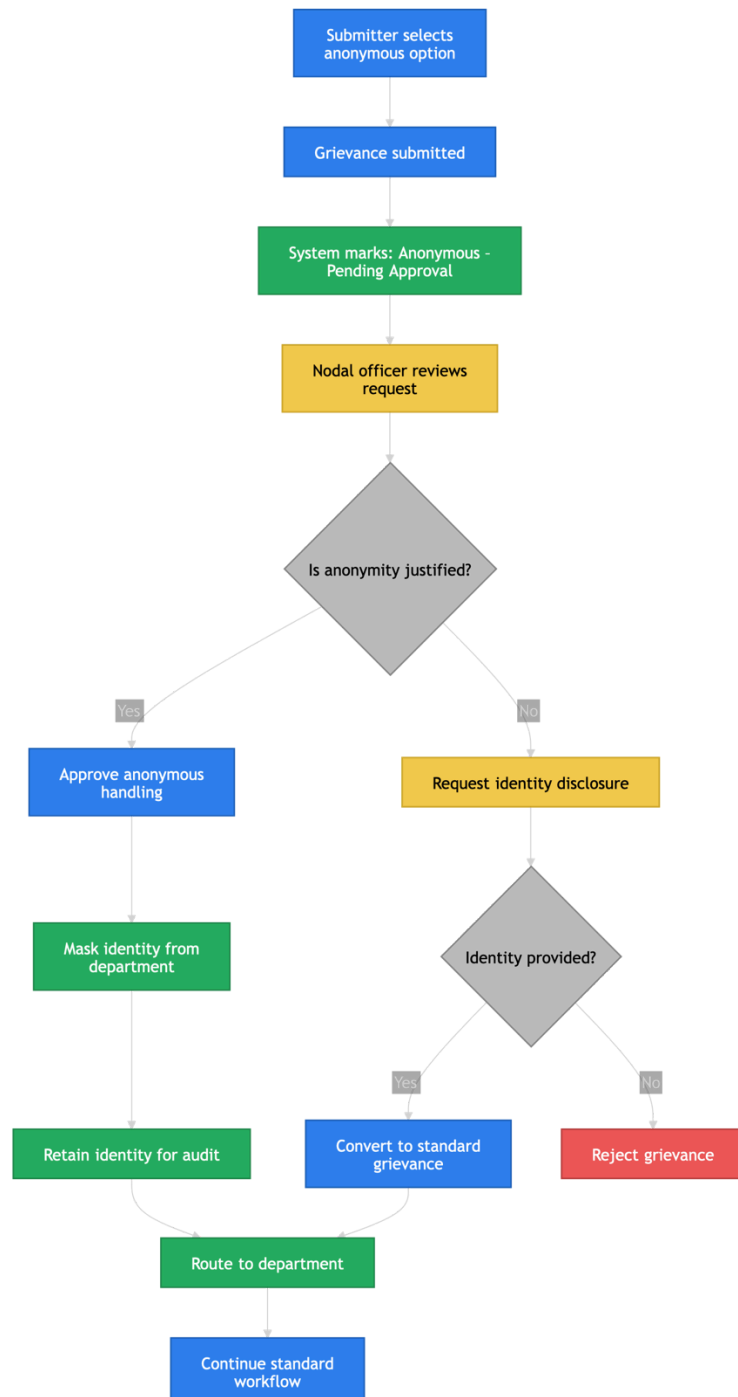
9.1 Internal Reassignment for Workload Management

Departments shall have the ability to internally reassign grievances among officers to balance workload and ensure SLA compliance. Reassignment actions shall be logged in the audit trail, capturing original assignee, new assignee, timestamp, and reason.



9.2 Anonymous Grievance Submission with Approval Workflow

Farmers may choose to submit grievances anonymously for sensitive issues. Such submissions shall trigger an approval workflow handled by a designated authority (e.g., nodal officer). The authority shall review the request and either approve anonymous handling or require identity disclosure before routing. Approved anonymous grievances shall mask submitter identity from department officers while retaining encrypted identity linkage for audit purposes.



Appendix A: Submitter Types Reference

This appendix provides a comprehensive reference for all authorized submitter types within the OAN Grievance Management Module. Each submitter type has distinct identity requirements, available submission channels, and additional data fields captured at the time of submission.

Individual Farmer

The primary submitter type. An individual registered farmer submitting a grievance in their own name regarding a service they have directly received or been denied.

Identity verification	Fayda ID (primary); OTP via registered mobile (fallback)
Channels	Mobile app (Android), IVR, web portal, Development Agent assisted
Additional fields	Farmer ID, land parcel reference, crop type, service provider linked from OAN registry
Representative	N/A — submitter is the primary owner
Offline support	Yes — mobile app syncs on reconnect; IVR calling available on feature phones

Cooperative / Farmer Producer Organization (FPO)

A registered cooperative or FPO submitting a grievance on behalf of its member farmers, typically related to collective input procurement, market access, or payment disputes.

Identity verification	Organization registration number + authorized representative Fayda ID
Channels	Web portal, Development Agent assisted, call center
Additional fields	Organization name, registration number, authorized representative name, member count affected, area of operation
Representative	Authorized representative named at submission; organization remains primary owner
Offline support	Partial — web portal responsive

Non-Governmental Organization (NGO)

A registered NGO submitting a grievance on behalf of farmers or communities it serves, particularly for systemic or area-wide issues.

Identity verification	Organization name + authorized representative Fayda ID
Channels	Web portal, call center
Additional fields	Organization name, area covered (Woreda/Kebele), authorized representative name and contact, number of affected individuals (if known)
Representative	Authorized representative named at submission
Offline support	No — web portal only

Woreda/Kebele Representative

An official administrative body at the Woreda or Kebele level submitting a grievance on behalf of its constituency. This replaces the former 'village body' classification. Note: Panchayat is not an applicable administrative structure within the Ethiopian context and is not supported.

Identity verification	Body registration or official mandate + representative Fayda ID
Channels	Web portal, call center, Development Agent assisted
Additional fields	Body name, Woreda/Kebele, authorized representative name and role, population or area affected
Representative	Named official representative; body is primary owner
Offline support	Partial — Development Agent may assist with submission

Development Agent (On Behalf of Farmer)

A trained OAN Development Agent submitting a grievance on behalf of a farmer who lacks digital access. The farmer remains the primary owner of the grievance; the officer's identity is recorded for audit purposes.

Identity verification	Officer ID (authenticated in OAN system) + farmer Fayda ID or mobile OTP for identity linkage
Channels	Mobile app (Android), web portal

Additional fields

Officer ID, officer name, officer zone/region; all primary fields captured for the farmer

Representative

Officer is logged as submitter-on-behalf; farmer is primary grievance owner

Offline support

Yes — mobile app offline-first with sync on reconnect

Appendix B: Workflow Diagrams

The following diagrams illustrate the three core workflows of the Grievance Management Module. Each diagram is color-coded consistently: blue for process steps, green for system notifications and successful outcomes, amber for investigation and manual actions, red for escalation paths, and grey for decision points.

B-1: Grievance Submission and Ticketing Workflow

Covers the end-to-end flow from submitter authentication through channel selection, form completion, validation, ticket generation, acknowledgement, and routing to the responsible department.

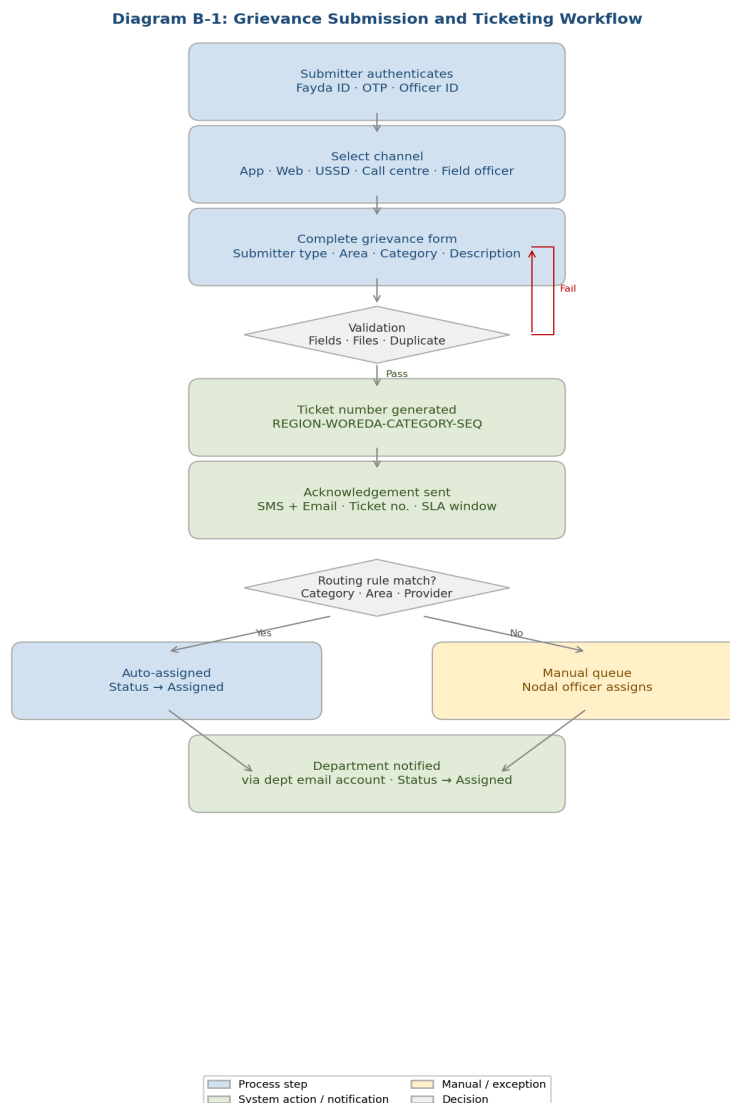


Figure B-1 – Grievance Submission and Ticketing Workflow

B-2: Department Response and Resolution Workflow

Covers the department officer's workflow from receiving a grievance through investigation, structured response submission, submitter notification, and the three possible outcomes: confirmed closure, submitter-initiated reopen, or auto-closure after the confirmation window expires.

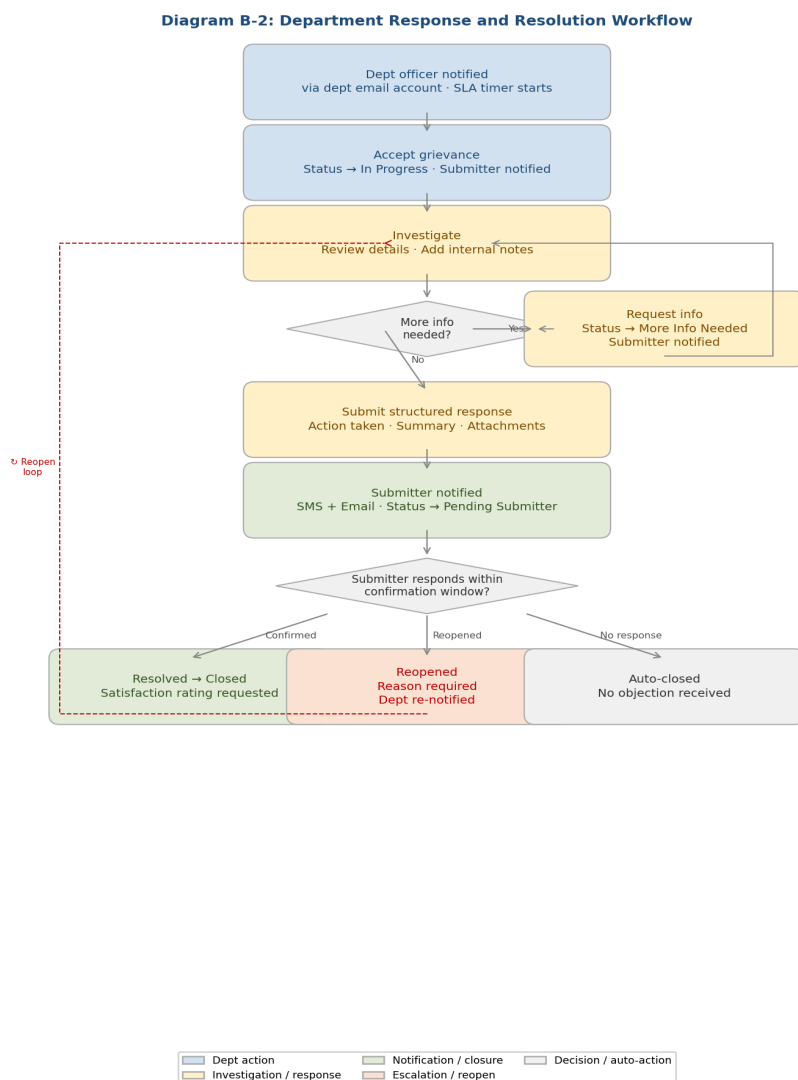


Figure B-2 – Department Response and Resolution Workflow

B-3: SLA Breach and Escalation Workflow

Covers the automated escalation process triggered by SLA deadline monitoring, including 50% and 80% reminders, first-level escalation on breach, second-level escalation at 2× SLA, manual escalation by the submitter, and the path back to normal resolution.

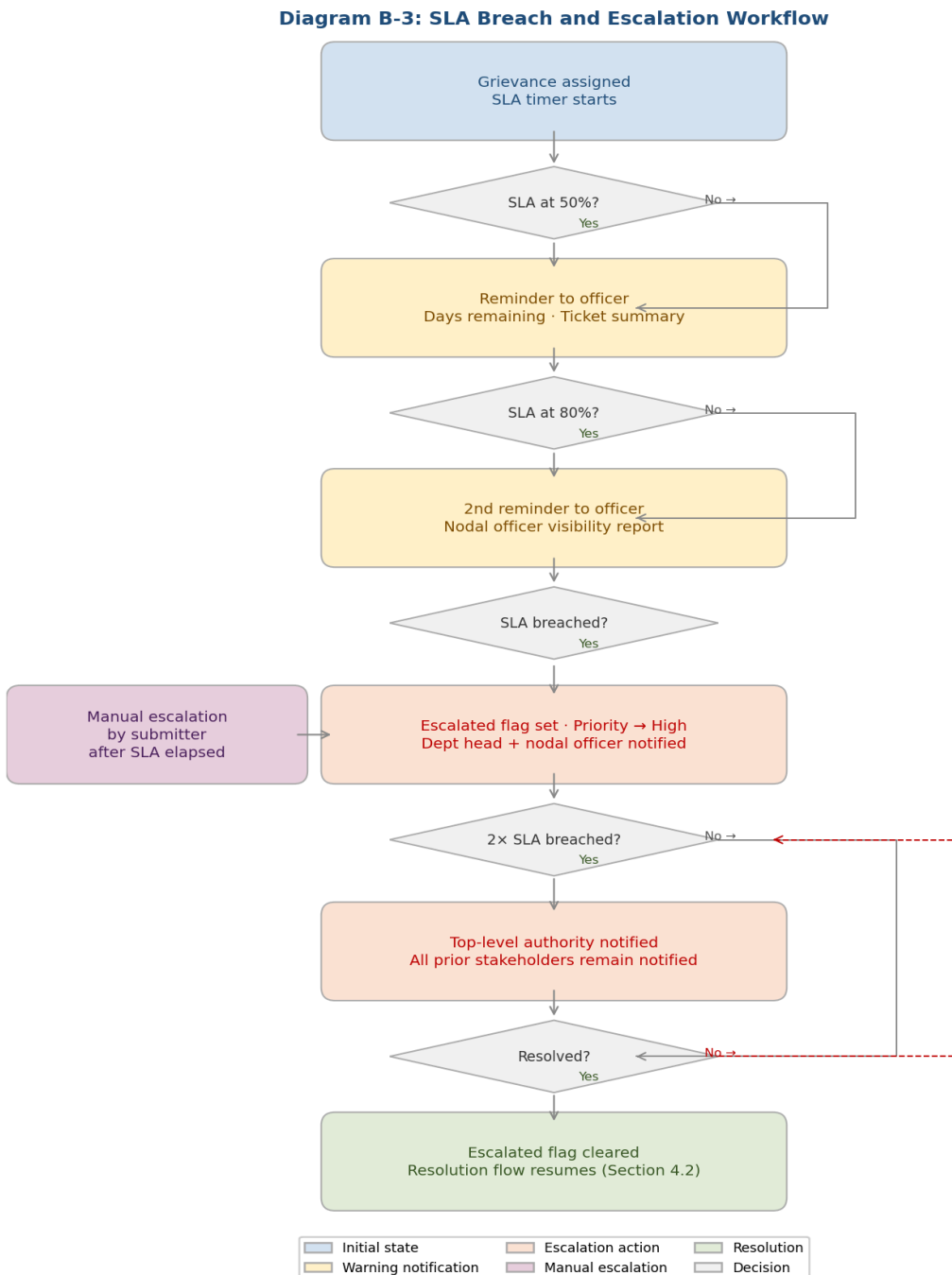
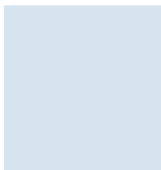


Figure B-3 – SLA Breach and Escalation Workflow

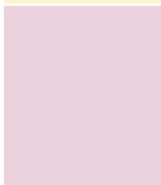
B-4: Diagram Color Key



Process / dept action step



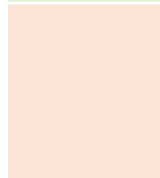
Investigation / manual action /
warning



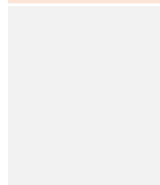
Manual submitter action



System notification / successful
outcome



Escalation / reopen path



Decision point / auto-action

Appendix C: Notification Matrix

The following table defines every notification event within the Grievance Management Module: who receives it, via which channel(s), when it is triggered, and what it contains. All SMS messages are **localized** in Amharic and English. Email notifications are sent from the relevant department's configured email account where applicable.

Event	Recipient(s)	Channel	Trigger	Content
Submission received	Submitter	SMS + Email	Immediately on save	Ticket number, category, assigned dept (if known), SLA window, portal link
Duplicate detected	Submitter	SMS + Email	On validation	Warning, existing ticket number, option to link or proceed
Grievance assigned (auto)	Dept officer	Dept email	On auto-routing match	Full ticket details, submitter info, SLA deadline, portal link
Grievance assigned (manual)	Dept officer	Dept email	On nodal officer assignment	Full ticket details, submitter info, SLA deadline, portal link
Status → In Progress	Submitter	SMS	Officer accepts ticket	Status update, dept name, officer contact
More info requested	Submitter	SMS + Email	Officer sets More Info Needed	Specific information requested, response deadline, portal link
Submitter responds to info	Dept officer	Dept email	Submitter provides info	Submitter's response, ticket reference, updated details
Structured response sent	Submitter	SMS + Email	Officer submits response	Action taken summary, resolution detail, attachments, proposed close date, confirmation instructions

Event	Recipient(s)	Channel	Trigger	Content
Confirmation window open	Submitter	SMS	Response submitted	Confirm or reopen instructions, window deadline, SMS code or portal link
Grievance confirmed/resolved	Submitter	SMS + Email	Submitter confirms	Closure confirmation, satisfaction rating prompt
Grievance reopened	Dept officer	Dept email	Submitter reopens	Reopen reason, submitter details, updated ticket status
Auto-closed (no response)	Submitter	SMS + Email	Confirmation window expires	Auto-closure notice, feedback prompt, reference number
Grievance closed	Submitter	SMS + Email	On final closure	Closure summary, satisfaction rating prompt, portal link
SLA reminder – <50>%	Assigned officer	Email	Scheduled job	Remaining SLA days, ticket summary, action prompt
SLA reminder – 80%	Assigned officer	Email	Scheduled job	Remaining SLA days, urgent action prompt
SLA at-risk report	Nodal officer	Email	Scheduled job (at 80%)	List of all tickets approaching SLA deadline
SLA breached – L1	Dept head + nodal officer	Email	SLA deadline passed	Ticket details, days overdue, escalation notice, action required
SLA breached – L2	Top-level authority	Email	2× SLA deadline passed	Escalation summary, full history, stakeholders notified

Event	Recipient(s)	Channel	Trigger	Content
Manual escalation	Dept head + nodal officer	Email	Submitter triggers escalation	Same content as L1 breach; triggered-by: submitter
Reassignment requested	Nodal officer	Email	Officer requests reassign	Original dept, reassignment reason, ticket details

Note: The system shall implement controls to prevent excessive or redundant notifications. Where multiple events occur in quick succession (for example, auto-assignment immediately following submission), notifications may be batched into a single message.

Appendix D: Department Response Structure

This appendix defines the complete structure of the formal response that a department officer must submit when acting on an assigned grievance. Each response entry is immutably appended to the grievance record and forms part of the official audit trail. A grievance may accumulate multiple response entries if it is reopened.

D-1: Response Form Fields

Field	Type	Required	Description
Response date	Date/time	Yes (auto)	Auto-populated at the moment the officer submits the response. Not editable.
Action taken	Text	Yes	A concise summary (max 500 characters) of the specific steps the department has taken in response to the grievance.
Resolution summary	Rich text	Yes	A detailed explanation of the investigation outcome, findings, and the resolution reached or proposed. Supports formatting.
Supporting attachments	File(s)	No	Photos, documents, or other evidence demonstrating the action taken. Accepted formats: JPG, PNG, PDF, DOCX. Max 10 MB per file, max 5 files.

Field	Type	Required	Description
Proposed closure date	Date	Yes	The date by which the department expects the matter to be fully resolved. Used to set submitter expectations and track follow-up.
Response type	Select	Yes	Options: Resolved, Partially Resolved, Referred to another dept, Requires further info. Determines next workflow step.
Responded by	Link	Yes (auto)	Linked to the authenticated officer's user profile. Auto-populated AND not editable.
Internal notes	Text	No	Internal-only notes not visible to the submitter. For departmental record-keeping only.

D-2: Response Type Outcomes

The Response Type field drives the next step in the workflow:

Response type	Status after submission	What happens next
Resolved	Pending Submitter	Confirmation window opens. Submitter confirms or reopens within 7 days.
Partially Resolved	Pending Submitter	Confirmation window opens. Submitter may confirm partial resolution or reopen with outstanding issues.
Referred to another dept	Assigned	Nodal officer is notified to reassign. Original dept's response is logged. SLA resets from reassignment date.

Response type	Status after submission	What happens next
Requires further info	More Info Needed	Submitter is notified with the specific information requested. Response clock pauses until submitter replies.

D-3: Response Entry Audit Record

Each submitted response is stored as an immutable child record of the grievance. The following fields are auto-captured by the system and cannot be altered:

Audit field	Value captured
Submission timestamp	Exact date and time of response submission (UTC)
Responded by (user ID)	Authenticated user ID of the submitting officer
IP address	IP address from which the response was submitted
Response sequence no.	Sequential number of this response entry for this grievance (e.g. Response #1, #2)
Prior status	The grievance status immediately before this response was submitted
New status	The grievance status set as a result of this response
Notification sent	Confirmation that submitter notification was dispatched (timestamp + channel)

D-4: Response Visibility Rules

Field	Visible to submitter	Visible to dept officer	Visible to nodal officer / admin
Action taken	Yes	Yes	Yes

Field	Visible to submitter	Visible to dept officer	Visible to nodal officer / admin
Resolution summary	Yes	Yes	Yes
Supporting attachments	Yes	Yes	Yes
Proposed closure date	Yes	Yes	Yes
Response type	Yes	Yes	Yes
Internal notes	No	Yes	Yes
IP address	No	No	Yes
Responded by	Name only	Full profile	Full profile

Appendix E: Detailed Use Cases

UC-01: Submit Grievance

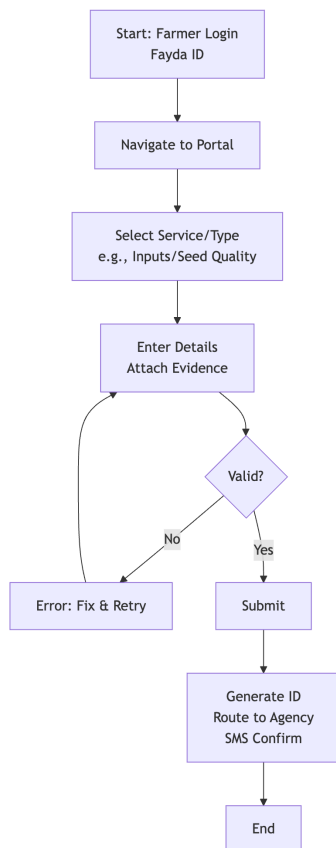
Primary actor

Farmer / cooperative / FPO / NGO / Woreda/Kebele representative /
Development Agent (on behalf)

Trigger

Submitter wishes to formally register a grievance related to an agricultural service.

Description



This use case describes the end-to-end process by which any authorized submitter registers a grievance across any supported channel. The system ensures formal recording, unique identification, and immediate routing.

Preconditions

- Submitter is authenticated via Fayda ID, organizational credentials, or approved fallback.
- Submitter's profile exists within OAN and is linked to relevant context.
- Grievance submission interface is accessible via at least one channel.

Postconditions

- A new grievance record is created with a unique ticket number (e.g. OROM-BISH-AGRN-12345).
- The grievance is categorized and routed to the appropriate department (or placed in manual queue).
- A confirmation notification is sent to the submitter via SMS and/or email with ticket number, category, and SLA window.

Main flow

1. Submitter accesses the grievance section via their chosen channel.
2. System presents the submitter type selector; submitter identifies their type.
3. Submitter selects a service category and grievance type.
4. System loads a context-aware form. Cooperatives, NGOs, and Woreda/Kebele bodies are prompted for additional org fields.
5. Submitter completes the form, optionally attaches evidence, and submits.
6. System validates mandatory fields, file constraints, identity linkage, and duplicate detection.
7. On successful validation: ticket number generated, status set to "Submitted", routing triggered, acknowledgement sent.

Alternative flows

- A1 – Cooperative / NGO / Woreda/Kebele body: authorized representative selects their organization from the registry. Additional org fields are required.
- A2 – Development Agent on behalf: officer enters data; officer ID recorded; farmer's Fayda ID or mobile is linked as primary owner.
- A3 – IVR channel: simplified linear flow; no attachments; submitter advised resubmitting via app or portal for evidence.

Exceptions

- E1 – Authentication failure: system halts and prompts re-authentication.
- E2 – Invalid or oversized attachments: clear error with accepted formats and size limits.
- E3 – Duplicate detected: system alerts submitter and offers option to link to existing grievance or proceed with justification.

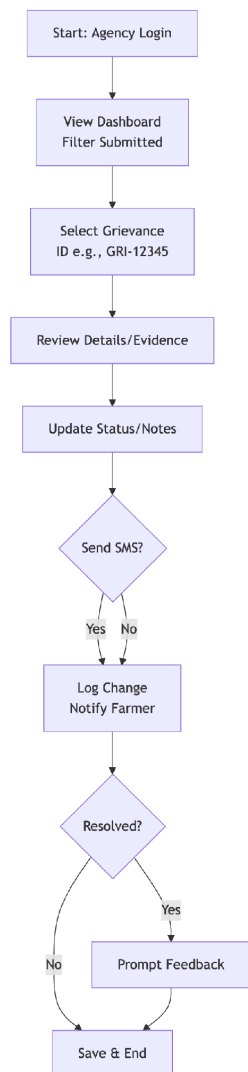
UC-02: Department Officer Processes and Responds to Grievance

Primary actor

Department officer (government body or private agency)

Trigger

A grievance is assigned to the officer's department.



Preconditions

- The officer is authenticated and authorized under RBAC for their department.

- The grievance is visible in the officer's work queue with status "Assigned" or "In Progress".

Postconditions

- A structured response entry is appended to the grievance audit trail.
- The submitter is automatically notified via SMS and email.
- Status advances to "Pending Submitter" and the confirmation window opens.

Main flow

1. Officer logs into portal and accesses their grievance dashboard.
2. Officer selects the assigned grievance and reviews all details.
3. Officer updates status to "In Progress"; submitter notified via SMS.
4. Officer conducts investigation, adding internal notes throughout.
5. Officer completes the structured response form (see Appendix D) and submits.
6. System saves the response, notifies submitter via SMS and email, and advances status to "Pending Submitter".

Alternative flows

- A1 – More info needed: officer sets status to "More Info Needed"; submitter is notified with specific request.
- A2 – Reassignment: officer requests reassignment via nodal officer queue if grievance is out of scope.

Exceptions

- E1 – Unauthorized access: system denies access and logs the attempt.

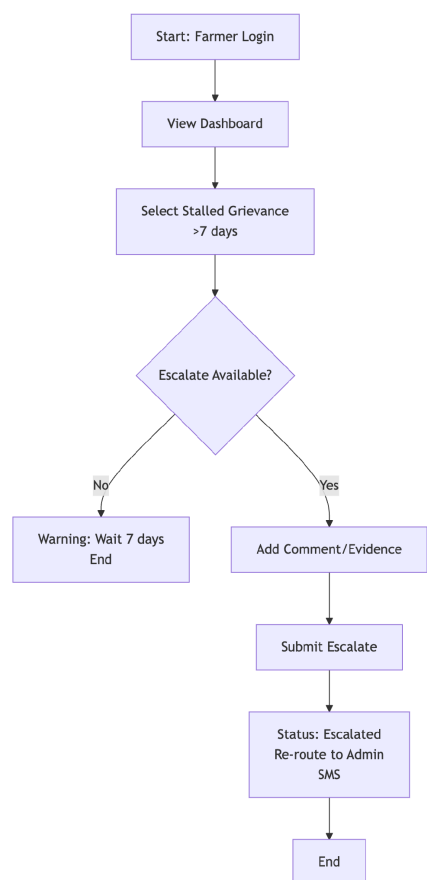
UC-03: Submitter Confirms Resolution or Reopens Grievance

Primary actor

Farmer / cooperative / FPO / NGO / Woreda/Kebele body (original submitter)

Trigger

Submitter receives a department response notification and the confirmation window is open.



Preconditions

- Status is "Pending Submitter" and the confirmation window is open.

Postconditions

- Confirmed: status advances to "Resolved" then "Closed"; feedback is solicited.
- Reopened: status reverts to "In Progress"; department is re-notified with reopen reason.

Main flow

1. Submitter receives SMS/email notification with the department's response.
2. Submitter logs into portal (or responds via SMS code) to view full response.
3. Submitter selects "Confirm Resolution" or "Reopen Grievance".
4. If confirmed: system advances status, schedules auto-close, prompts for satisfaction rating.
5. If reopened: submitter enters mandatory reason; system reverts status and notifies department.

Alternative flows

- A1 – No response within window: system auto-closes ("Closed – no objection received") and sends final notification.

UC-04: Auto-Escalation on SLA Breach

Primary actor	System (scheduled process)
Secondary actors	Department head, nodal officer, senior authority
Trigger	A grievance's SLA deadline is reached without resolution.

Main flow

1. Scheduled job identifies grievances where `creation_date + sla_days < today` and status is open.
2. System sets `Escalated = true`, `priority = High`.
3. Notification dispatched to department head and nodal officer via email.
4. Escalation event recorded in audit log.
5. If 2× SLA also breached: second-level escalation to top-level authority triggered.

Alternative flows

- A1 – Manual escalation by submitter: submitter selects Escalate in the portal after SLA elapsed; same steps 2–5 execute with `triggered-by = submitter`.

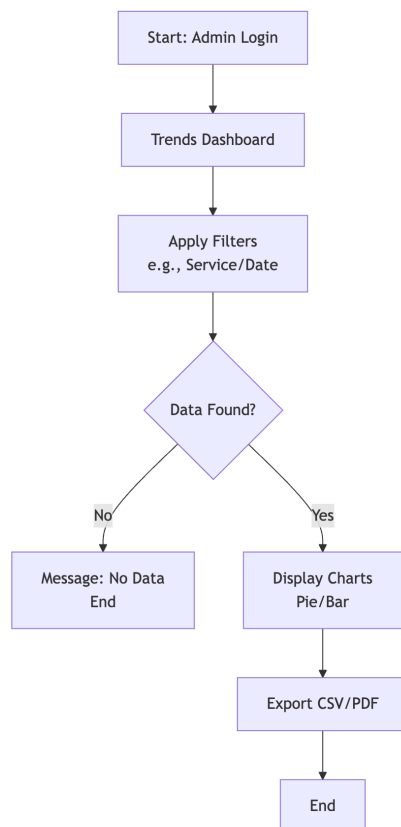
UC-05: Generate Trends Report

Primary actor

OAN Administrator

Trigger

Administrator requires insight into grievance volumes, resolution performance, or systemic issues.



Main flow

1. Administrator accesses the analytics dashboard.
2. Administrator applies filters: service category, geographic region, time period, department, submitter type.
3. System displays visualizations on the Dashboard: grievance volume, average resolution times, SLA compliance rates, escalation counts.
4. Administrator selects export format (CSV or PDF) and downloads report.

Appendix F: RBAC and Access Control Matrix

This matrix operationalises the approved role model. Permissions are evaluated against the active user, assigned case, configured category/department/region scope, and any approved reassignment or approval-queue permission.

Role / access group	Users	Default scope	Key permissions
Farmer	Individual farmer; direct cooperative/FPO, NGO, or Woreda/Kebele submitter	Own grievances only	Submit, save draft, view own details, respond to information requests, confirm/reopen, escalate after SLA; no assignment/configuration access.
Assisted-Submissions	Development Agent submitting on behalf of a farmer	Assisted submissions recorded against the officer	Create/update assisted submission, attach evidence, view workflow state, respond to requests where permitted; farmer remains primary owner.
L1 Nodal Officer	First-level case-routing/handling officer	Assigned cases within configured category + department + region	Review, status updates, internal notes, response workflow, initiate reassignment with mandatory reason; cannot approve own reassignment.
L2 Senior Nodal Officer	Senior nodal/approval officer	Assigned cases + configured approval queues	Manage SLAs and deferrals; approve/reject deferrals and reassignment requests; supervise configured category/department/region; immutable decision log.
Department Head	Head of responsible department	Assigned cases + department oversight/approval scope	Act on assigned cases; manage department SLA/deferrals; oversee department queue; approve department actions permitted by policy.
OAN Administrator-ATI	ATI platform administrator	All regions, departments, categories	Manage users, roles/scopes, routing, category assignments, SLAs, notifications, templates, dashboards, reassignment controls, and audit access; cannot delete immutable records.